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Akash Chaudhary, PhD

UX Researcher/Designer

About Me

I am an **end-to end UX** researcher/designer with background in **psychology** and **linguistics**. I leverage my PhD skills and **5+ year UX research experience** to support multiple stakeholder perspectives in generating actionable user insights. I use **mixed-methods analysis** to generate formative, descriptive and summative inferences for driving product innovations. In my personal time, I like playing soccer and eating dark chocolates.

Skills

Qualitative Methods
Interview, participant observations, ethnography, focus groups, think-aloud tests, survey-questionnaires, subject-matter expert tests, user personas, journey maps, diary study, storyboards
Analysis Methods: Thematic analysis, content analysis, grounded theory, discourse analysis

Quantitative Methods
Usability tests (SUS), User experience questionnaires (SEQ, UEQ)
Analysis Methods: Descriptive statistics, Inferential statistics (Linear/logistic regression, chi-square tests, ANOVA, odds ratio analysis, pre-to-post test learning gain)

Tools and Programming Languages:
Figma, Qualtrics, Typeform, Google Slides, Python, CSS, HTML, P5, Javascript

Project Management
Conducting end-to-end UX research, working across cross-functional teams (Design, Operations and Tech).

Communication
Collaborating with subject-matter experts to discover and communicate UX improvements among stakeholders.

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz
MS, Computational Media

Indian Institute of Technology, Roorkee
B. Tech, Production and Industrial Engineering

Experience

UX Graduate Student Researcher | University of California, Santa Cruz, US
September 2021 - Present

- **Conducted ethnographic research** with strawberry farm workers to design a health tracking application.
- Used participant observations, interviews, workshop studies and a longitudinal study for observing worker data and presented it back to farm workers for gathering feedback on design insights. This work got published at at **ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2025**.
- Conducted **end-to-end user research** to identify dark patterns on video streaming platforms.
- Gathered survey and interview feedbacks to formulate and conduct a diary study, discovering user pain points. Analyzed 4 famous video streaming platforms in India: Netflix, Youtube, PrimeVideo and Disney+ Hotstar to discover 5 categories of new dark patterns. **36 leading researchers at top-tier conferences cited** and used our dark pattern classification to inform HCI research community of harmful UI patterns.
- Led a team of 3 and communicated paper insights at **ACM Designing Interactive Systems 2022**.
- Mentored students as a teaching assistant for 6 months.

UX Research Associate | Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology, Delhi, India
January 2018 - July 2021

- **Conducted linguistic audio UX research** with non-native speakers to design and develop an educational mobile application.
- Collaborated with cross functions teams, visual communication, coding and design teams to create 12 audio-visual tech designs. Tested design effectiveness with design students to come up with an optimal design, translating user insights into actionable design solutions.
- Conducted usability testing sessions for insights on key design features. Received an **SUS score of 82.3/100** which is among top 10 percentiles of usability scores.
- Presented and communicated research insights for a full paper accepted at **ACM Mobile HCI 2021**.